

Business Communication ■ Mid Term Notes

Week-1 Notes

1. What is Communication

Communication is the process of sending and receiving information, ideas, thoughts, and feelings between two or more people to achieve mutual understanding.

In business communication, communication is more than just talking — it includes writing, listening, reading, body language, and digital communication.

According to *Excellence in Business Communication*, communication plays a vital role in professional success and organizational effectiveness.

Simple Explanation

Communication happens when:

- One person sends a message
- Another person receives it
- Both understand the message clearly

If understanding does not occur, communication is not successful.

Example

Manager → "Submit the report by 5 PM"

Employee → Understands and submits report before 5 PM

✓ Communication successful

If employee misunderstands and submits next day

✗ Communication failed

2. Importance of Communication

Communication is extremely important in every aspect of business and daily life.

Importance in Business

1. Helps in Decision Making

Managers need accurate information to make decisions.

Example:

Sales department communicates declining sales → Management reduces prices

2. Improves Organizational Efficiency

Clear communication reduces confusion and errors.

Example:

Clear instructions = less mistakes

3. Builds Good Relationships

Communication helps build relationships between:

- Employees
- Managers
- Customers
- Suppliers

4. Improves Teamwork

Communication helps employees work together effectively.

5. Helps in Problem Solving

Without communication, problems cannot be identified or solved.

6. Improves Customer Satisfaction

Businesses communicate with customers through:

- Emails
- Calls
- Advertisements
- Social Media

3. Importance of Effective Communication

Communication alone is not enough — it must be effective.

What is Effective Communication?

Effective communication means:

- Message is clear
- Message is understood correctly
- Desired response is achieved

Why Effective Communication is Important

1. Avoids Misunderstanding

Clear communication prevents confusion.

2. Improves Productivity

Employees work efficiently when instructions are clear.

3. Builds Professional Image

Professionals with good communication skills succeed faster.

4. Improves Leadership

Leaders communicate vision and goals effectively.

5. Helps in Career Growth

Communication is considered one of the **most important professional skills**.

Example of Effective Communication

✗ Ineffective Communication

"Finish work soon"

✓ Effective Communication

"Please complete the sales report by 3 PM today"

4. Concept and Scope of Communication

Concept of Communication

Communication is:

- A continuous process
- Two-way process
- Dynamic process
- Interactive process

Communication involves:

- Sender
- Message
- Receiver
- Feedback

Scope of Communication

Communication is used in:

1. Business Communication

Communication within organizations

2. Personal Communication

Communication in daily life

3. Organizational Communication

Communication inside company

4. Mass Communication

Communication to large audience

Examples:

- TV
- Radio
- Newspapers
- Social media

Scope of Communication in Business

Communication is used in:

- Meetings
- Emails
- Reports
- Presentations
- Interviews
- Negotiations
- Customer service

5. Definitions of Communication

Definition 1

Communication is the process of transmitting information and understanding from one person to another.

Definition 2

Communication is the exchange of ideas, facts, and feelings between individuals.

Definition 3

Communication is the process by which meaning is created and shared between people.

Definition 4 (Business Communication)

Business communication is the exchange of information within an organization and outside the organization.

6. The Communication Model

Communication Model explains **how communication works**.

Basic Communication Model

Elements of Communication Model

1. Sender
2. Message
3. Encoding
4. Channel
5. Receiver
6. Decoding
7. Feedback
8. Noise

7. Explanation of Communication Model

1. Sender

Person who sends message

Example:

Manager giving instructions

2. Message

Information sent by sender

Example:

"Submit report today"

3. Encoding

Converting ideas into words

Example:

Manager converts thought into instructions

4. Channel

Medium used to send message

Examples:

- Email
- Phone
- Letter
- Meeting

5. Receiver

Person who receives message

Example:

Employee

6. Decoding

Receiver interprets message

Example:

Employee understands instructions

7. Feedback

Receiver responds to sender

Example:

"Yes, I will submit report today"

8. Noise

Anything that disturbs communication

Examples:

- Poor network
- Noise
- Misunderstanding
- Language barrier

Example of Communication Model

Manager → "Complete project today"

(Employee receives message)

Employee → "Yes sir"

(Feedback)

Communication complete.

Week-2 Notes

1. Listening Skills

What is Listening?

Listening is the active process of receiving, understanding, interpreting, and responding to messages.

Listening is different from hearing.

- **Hearing** = Physical process
- **Listening** = Mental process

Example:

Manager explains instructions

Employee hears but doesn't understand → Hearing only

Employee understands and follows → Listening

Importance of Listening Skills

Listening is important because:

1. Improves Understanding

Helps understand instructions correctly

2. Reduces Mistakes

Good listeners make fewer errors

3. Builds Relationships

Listening shows respect

4. Improves Productivity

Employees complete tasks efficiently

5. Helps in Problem Solving

Listening helps identify issues

Types of Listening

1. Active Listening

Fully concentrating and responding

Example:

Employee asks questions after instructions

2. Passive Listening

Listening without full attention

Example:

Listening while using phone

3. Empathetic Listening

Understanding feelings and emotions

Example:

Manager listening to employee problems

4. Critical Listening

Evaluating information carefully

Example:

Manager analyzing proposal

Barriers to Effective Listening

- Noise
- Distractions
- Poor concentration
- Language problems
- Prejudice
- Emotional stress

Tips for Effective Listening

- Pay attention
- Maintain eye contact
- Avoid interrupting
- Ask questions
- Take notes
- Give feedback

2. Interpersonal Skills

What are Interpersonal Skills?

Interpersonal skills are the skills used to communicate and interact with others effectively.

These skills help in:

- Teamwork
- Leadership
- Negotiation
- Conflict resolution

Importance of Interpersonal Skills

1. Builds Relationships

Good interpersonal skills improve workplace relationships

2. Improves Teamwork

Employees collaborate effectively

3. Enhances Leadership

Leaders communicate better

4. Improves Workplace Environment

Reduces conflicts

Examples of Interpersonal Skills

- Listening
- Speaking
- Empathy
- Teamwork
- Negotiation
- Conflict resolution
- Emotional intelligence

Example

Manager communicates respectfully with employees

Employees feel motivated

Productivity increases

3. Nonverbal Communication

What is Nonverbal Communication?

Nonverbal communication is communication without using words.

It includes:

- Body language
- Facial expressions
- Eye contact
- Gestures
- Posture
- Tone of voice

Importance of Nonverbal Communication

- Supports verbal communication
- Shows emotions
- Builds trust
- Improves understanding

Types of Nonverbal Communication

1. Facial Expressions

Smile, anger, surprise

Example:

Manager smiling shows friendliness

2. Eye Contact

Shows confidence and interest

Example:

Maintaining eye contact during meeting

3. Gestures

Hand movements

Example:

Nodding head shows agreement

4. Posture

Body position

Example:

Standing straight shows confidence

5. Tone of Voice

Example:

Friendly tone vs angry tone

Example

Manager says "Good job"

But looks angry → Mixed communication

4. Barriers to Effective Communication

Barriers are obstacles that prevent effective communication.

Types of Barriers

1. Semantic Barriers

Semantic barriers occur due to language problems.

Examples:

- Difficult words
- Technical terms
- Poor grammar
- Misinterpretation

Example:

Manager uses technical terms

Employee does not understand

2. Psychological Barriers

Psychological barriers occur due to mental and emotional factors.

Examples:

- Stress
- Fear
- Anger
- Attitude

- Lack of trust

Example:

Employee afraid to ask questions

3. Organizational Barriers

Organizational barriers occur due to organizational structure.

Examples:

- Long communication chain
- Poor management
- Lack of clarity
- Information overload

Example:

Message passes through many managers

Information changes

4. Cultural Barriers

Cultural barriers occur due to **cultural differences**.

Examples:

- Language differences
- Beliefs
- Values
- Traditions

Example:

Gesture acceptable in one culture may be offensive in another

5. Physiological Barriers

Physiological barriers occur due to **physical conditions**.

Examples:

- Hearing problems
- Poor eyesight
- Illness
- Fatigue

Example:

Employee unable to hear instructions

Week-3 Notes

According to Part 1 of the book, communication in organizations involves interpersonal communication, collaboration, and communication within organizational structures, which supports effective decision-making and teamwork.

1. Organizational Communication

What is Organizational Communication?

Organizational communication is the process of exchanging information within an organization and between the organization and external environment.

It includes communication between:

- Managers and employees
- Departments
- Teams
- Organization and customers
- Organization and suppliers

Example

Manager sends instructions to employees

Employees report progress

Departments share information

This is organizational communication.

2. Types of Organizational Communication

Organizational communication is divided into:

1. Internal Communication

Communication within the organization

Examples:

- Manager to employees
- Department to department
- Team communication
- Meetings
- Emails

Importance:

- Improves coordination
- Improves teamwork
- Helps decision-making

2. External Communication

Communication outside the organization

Examples:

- Communication with customers
- Communication with suppliers
- Advertisements
- Press releases

Importance:

- Builds company reputation
- Improves customer relations
- Helps business growth

3. Types of Communication Flow

1. Downward Communication

Communication from top level to lower level

Examples:

- Manager gives instructions
- Policies announced

- Orders issued

Example:

CEO → Manager → Employees

2. Upward Communication

Communication from lower level to higher level

Examples:

- Feedback
- Reports
- Suggestions

Example:

Employees → Manager → CEO

3. Lateral or Horizontal Communication

Communication between same level employees

Examples:

- Department coordination
- Team communication

Example:

Marketing Department ↔ Sales Department

4. Vertical Communication

Vertical communication refers to communication that flows between different levels of hierarchy in an organization.

It includes:

- Downward Communication
- Upward Communication

Vertical communication occurs between:

- Managers and employees
- Supervisors and workers
- Top management and lower-level staff

Types of Vertical Communication

1. Downward Communication

2. Upward Communication

Importance of Vertical Communication

- Improves coordination
- Helps decision making
- Improves management control
- Enhances employee satisfaction
- Reduces misunderstanding

4. Why Organizational Communication Matters

Organizational communication is important because:

1. Improves Coordination

Departments work together effectively

2. Improves Decision Making

Managers receive accurate information

3. Reduces Conflicts

Clear communication avoids misunderstanding

4. Improves Productivity

Employees understand tasks clearly

5. Builds Strong Relationships

Communication builds trust

5. Sources of Information

Organizations rely on different sources of information for decision-making.

Types of Decision Making

1. Structured Decision Making

Decisions that follow clear rules and procedures

Example:

Salary calculation

Inventory reorder

2. Unstructured Decision Making

Decisions based on judgment and experience

Example:

Launching new product

Hiring executive

3. Semi-Structured Decision Making

Combination of structured and unstructured decisions

Example:

Budget planning

Marketing strategies

6. Four Directions of Communication Flow

1. Downward Communication

Top → Bottom

2. Upward Communication

Bottom → Top

3. Horizontal Communication

Same Level

4. Diagonal Communication

Communication between different departments and levels

Example:

Manager → Staff from another department

7. Key Theories of Organizational Communication

1. Classical Management Theory

Focus:

- Hierarchy
- Authority
- Rules

Features:

- Clear chain of command
- Centralized decision making

Example:

Military organization structure

2. Human Relations Theory**Focus:**

- Employee satisfaction
- Motivation
- Relationships

Features:

- Employees treated as humans
- Teamwork encouraged

Example:

Employee welfare programs

3. System Theory

Organization seen as system of interconnected parts

Features:

- Departments depend on each other
- Communication links all parts

Example:

Production depends on marketing and finance

4. Cultural Approach**Focus on:**

- Organizational culture
- Values
- Beliefs

Example:

Company promotes teamwork culture

8. Sources of Information**1. Primary Sources**

Original information collected directly

Examples:

- Surveys
- Interviews
- Observations
- Experiments

2. Secondary Sources

Information collected from existing sources

Examples:

- Books
- Reports
- Articles
- Websites

3. Tertiary Sources

Information compiled from primary and secondary sources

Examples:

- Encyclopedias
- Dictionaries
- Indexes
- Databases

➤ 2. Internal Communication

What is Internal Communication?

Internal communication is **communication that takes place within the organization.**

It occurs between:

- Employees
- Managers
- Departments
- Teams

Examples of Internal Communication

- Emails
- Meetings
- Memos
- Reports
- Internal announcements

Importance of Internal Communication

- Improves teamwork
- Reduces conflict
- Improves productivity
- Helps decision making
- Improves employee morale

➤ External Communication

What is External Communication?

External communication is communication between organization and external parties.

External parties include:

- Customers
- Suppliers
- Government

- Investors
- Public

Examples of External Communication

- Advertisements
- Customer emails
- Press releases
- Business letters
- Social media posts

Importance of External Communication

- Builds company reputation
- Improves customer relations
- Promotes products
- Supports business growth

Difference Between Internal and External Communication

Internal Communication	External Communication
Inside organization	Outside organization
Employees and managers	Customers and public
Improves coordination	Builds reputation
Example: Meetings	Example: Advertisements

➤ Formal Communication

What is Formal Communication?

Formal communication is official communication that follows organizational structure.

It follows:

- Rules
- Procedures
- Hierarchy

Examples of Formal Communication

- Official emails
- Reports
- Letters
- Meetings
- Memos

Types of Formal Communication

- Vertical communication
- Horizontal communication
- Diagonal communication

Importance of Formal Communication

- Clear instructions

- Proper documentation
- Maintains discipline
- Improves accountability

➤ **Informal Communication**

What is Informal Communication?

Informal communication is unofficial communication that occurs naturally among employees. It is also called **Grapevine Communication**.

Examples of Informal Communication

- Casual conversation
- Social media chat
- Lunch discussion
- Friendly talk

Types of Informal Communication

1. Single Strand Chain

One person tells another

2. Gossip Chain

One person tells many people

3. Probability Chain

Random communication

4. Cluster Chain

One person tells selected group

Importance of Informal Communication

- Builds relationships
- Improves workplace environment
- Speeds communication
- Improves teamwork

Difference Between Formal and Informal Communication

Formal Communication	Informal Communication
Official	Unofficial
Structured	Unstructured
Follows hierarchy	No hierarchy
Written or official	Casual conversation

Week-4 Notes

According to Chapter 4, modern business requires professionals to communicate with people from different cultures, backgrounds, and regions, making cross-cultural communication essential in today's global marketplace.

1. Global Awareness

What is Global Awareness?

Global awareness means understanding cultural, social, economic, and political differences across countries and regions.

In business communication, global awareness helps professionals:

- Work with international clients
- Communicate with diverse teams
- Avoid misunderstandings
- Expand business globally

Importance of Global Awareness

1. Helps International Business

Companies operate globally

2. Improves Communication

Understanding cultural differences improves communication

3. Builds Relationships

Respect for cultural differences builds trust

4. Prevents Conflicts

Avoids cultural misunderstandings

2. Challenges and Opportunities of Communicating Cross-Culturally

Challenges

- Language differences
- Cultural differences
- Communication styles
- Values and beliefs
- Nonverbal differences

Opportunities

- Global business growth
- Innovation
- Diverse ideas
- Better problem-solving
- Stronger international relationships

3. Building Blocks: Understanding Culture

Understanding culture occurs at three levels:

1. Communication in Your Backyard (Local Interaction)

Communication within:

- Same city
- Same community
- Same culture

Example

Communication between coworkers from same city

2. Moving Up (Regional Communication)

Communication between:

- Different regions
- Different provinces
- Different languages

Example

Communication between Sindh and Punjab employees

3. Going Global (World Stage Communication)

Communication between:

- Different countries
- Different cultures
- International markets

Example

Pakistani company communicating with UK client

4. Intercultural Communication

What is Intercultural Communication?

Intercultural communication is communication between people from different cultures.

It includes differences in:

- Language
- Values
- Behavior
- Traditions
- Communication styles

Example

American manager → Direct communication

Asian employee → Indirect communication

Misunderstanding occurs due to cultural difference

5. Cultural Iceberg Theory

Culture is like an iceberg:

Visible Culture (Above Surface)

- Dress
- Food
- Language
- Behavior

Hidden Culture (Below Surface)

- Values
- Beliefs
- Attitudes
- Thinking patterns

Most cultural differences exist below the surface.

6. Challenges of Cross-Cultural Communication

1. Language Differences

Different languages create misunderstanding

2. Nonverbal Differences

Gestures vary across cultures

Example:

Thumbs up positive in some cultures, offensive in others

3. Different Communication Styles

- Direct communication
- Indirect communication

4. Values and Beliefs

Different attitudes toward:

- Time
- Authority
- Relationships

7. Strategies for Effective Cross-Cultural Communication

1. Cultural Intelligence

Understanding cultural differences and adapting behavior.

Example:

Learning local customs before meeting

2. Training and Development (T&D)

Organizations provide:

- Cultural training
- Communication training

3. Encourage Diversity and Inclusion

Promoting workplace diversity improves communication.

4. Use of Technology

Technology helps:

- Translation tools
- Virtual meetings
- Global collaboration

5. Mindful Communication

- Speak clearly
- Avoid slang
- Be respectful

6. Leadership Role

Leaders should:

- Promote diversity
- Encourage respect
- Support global teams

8. Related Concepts

1. Preconceived Ideas

Judging others before knowing them.

Example:

Assuming someone is lazy based on nationality

2. Selective Perception

Understanding only what we want to see.

Example:

Ignoring positive qualities of other culture

3. Stereotyping

Generalizing about group of people.

Example:

"All Americans are direct"

4. Tunnel Vision

Seeing only one perspective.

Example:

Ignoring other cultural viewpoints

5. Ethnocentrism

Believing one's culture is superior.

Example:

"My culture is better than others"

6. Xenophobia

Fear or dislike of foreigners.

Example:

Avoiding working with international employees

Impact of this barrier

Reduced opportunities

Increased conflict

Language and cultural barriers

Week-5 Notes

According to Chapter 3, teamwork is essential in modern organizations because teams combine skills, share knowledge, and improve decision-making and communication.

1. What is a Team?

A team is a group of people working together to achieve a common goal.

Key Elements of a Team

- Two or more people
- Common objective

- Shared responsibility
- Collaboration

Example

Marketing team working to launch a new product.

2. Types of Teams

Organizations use different types of teams depending on goals.

1. Functional Teams

Members from same department

Example: Sales Team

2. Cross-Functional Teams

Members from different departments

Example: Marketing + Finance + HR

3. Virtual Teams

Team members work from different locations

Example: Remote employees

4. Problem-Solving Teams

Created to solve specific issues

Example: Customer complaint team

5. Project Teams

Created for temporary projects

Example: New product development team

6. Self-Managed Teams

Teams manage their own work

Example: Production team managing schedules

3. What is Collaboration?

Collaboration is working together to achieve common goals.

It involves:

- Sharing ideas
- Sharing responsibilities
- Supporting each other

Example

Team members sharing ideas for marketing campaign.

4. Participative Management

Participative management means employees participate in decision-making.

Benefits

- Employees feel valued
- Better decisions
- Improved motivation

Example

Manager asks team members for suggestions before decision.

5. Common Types of Business Teams**1. Committee**

Permanent team handling regular tasks

Example: HR committee

2. Problem-Solving Team

Focuses on solving specific problems

Example: Quality improvement team

3. Project Team

Temporary team for specific project

Example: Software development team

4. Creative Team

Focuses on innovation and ideas

Example: Advertising team

5. Cross-Functional Team

Members from different departments

Example: Product launch team

6. Advantages of Teams**Benefits of Teams****1. More Information and Knowledge**

Multiple perspectives improve decisions

2. Learning Opportunities

Team members learn from each other

3. Boldness

Teams take better decisions

4. Accountability

Shared responsibility increases accountability

5. Trust Building

Teamwork builds trust

6. Buy-in for Solutions

Team members support decisions

7. Improved Performance

Better results through collaboration

8. Sense of Community

Support during difficult times

9. Sense of Belonging

Employees feel valued

7. Disadvantages of Teams

Challenges of Teams

1. Groupthink

Members agree without critical thinking

2. Hidden Agendas

Members may pursue personal goals

3. Cost

Teams require time and resources

4. Overload

Too many meetings waste time

8. Characteristics of Effective Teams

Effective teams have:

1. Clear Goals

Everyone understands objectives

2. Open Communication

Members share ideas freely

3. Mutual Trust

Members trust each other

4. Defined Roles

Each member has responsibilities

5. Leadership

Strong leadership guides team

6. Collaboration

Members work together

7. Accountability

Members take responsibility

9. Group Dynamics

Group dynamics refers to interaction between team members.

It includes:

- Behavior
- Attitudes
- Relationships

Good group dynamics lead to:

- Better teamwork
- Better communication
- Better performance

10. Team Dynamics

Team dynamics refers to how team members work together.

Factors affecting team dynamics:

- Communication
- Leadership
- Trust
- Roles
- Conflict

11. Team Roles

1. Task-Oriented Roles

Focus on completing tasks

Examples:

- Leader
- Coordinator
- Researcher
- Recorder

2. Team Maintenance Roles

Focus on maintaining relationships

Examples:

- Encourager
- Mediator
- Supporter
- Harmonizer

12. Stages of Team Development

1. Forming

Team members meet and get to know each other

2. Storming

Conflicts and disagreements occur

3. Norming

Team members agree on roles

4. Performing

Team works efficiently

5. Adjourning

Team completes project and disbands

Week-6 Detailed Notes

The book explains that effective business communication follows a systematic process known as the Three-Step Writing Process: Planning, Writing, and Completing, and emphasizes the importance of audience-centered communication.

PART 1 — Principles of Communication (The 7 Cs)

The 7 Cs of communication are the most important principles for writing clear, professional, and effective business messages.

1. Clarity

Clarity means the message should be clear, understandable, and easy to interpret.

Guidelines for Clarity

- Use simple words
- Avoid technical jargon
- Use short sentences
- Avoid ambiguity

Poor Example

"Your request will be processed soon."

Better Example

"Your request will be processed within two working days."

2. Conciseness

Conciseness means using minimum words without losing meaning.

Guidelines

- Avoid repetition
- Avoid unnecessary words
- Use short sentences

Wordy Sentence

"I am writing this letter to inform you that the meeting will be held tomorrow."

Concise Sentence

"The meeting will be held tomorrow."

3. Completeness

Completeness means providing all required information.

Incomplete Message

"Submit report."

Complete Message

"Submit the financial report by 3 PM today to the finance department."

Completeness Includes

- Who
- What
- When
- Where
- Why
- How

4. Correctness

Correctness means accurate facts and proper grammar.

Correctness Includes

- Grammar
- Spelling
- Facts
- Figures

Example

Incorrect:

"The report were submitted yesterday."

Correct:

"The report was submitted yesterday."

5. Concreteness

Concrete communication means specific and definite information.

Vague

"Sales increased significantly."

Concrete

"Sales increased by 18% in March."

6. Courtesy

Courtesy means being polite and respectful.

Impolite

"You must submit report immediately."

Polite

"Please submit the report at your earliest convenience."

7. Consideration

Consideration means focusing on audience needs.

Self-centered

"I need the report urgently."

Audience-centered

"Please send the report so we can complete the client presentation on time."

Summary of 7Cs

Principle	Meaning
Clarity	Clear message
Conciseness	Short and precise
Completeness	All information
Correctness	Accurate information
Concreteness	Specific facts
Courtesy	Polite tone
Consideration	Audience focused

PART 2 — The Three-Step Writing Process

The Three-Step Writing Process includes:

1. Planning
2. Writing
3. Completing

Step 1 — Planning

Planning is the most important stage of business communication.

Planning Includes

1. Analyzing the Situation

Ask:

- What is the purpose?
- Who is the audience?
- What information is needed?

2. Defining Purpose

Types of Purpose:

- Inform
- Persuade
- Request
- Respond

Example:

Purpose: Inform employees about meeting

3. Audience Analysis

Understand:

- Audience knowledge
- Audience attitude
- Audience expectations

Example:

Communication with manager vs customer differs

4. Gathering Information

Sources:

- Reports
- Research
- Data
- Interviews

Medium / Channel Selection

Choosing the correct medium is important.

Communication Channels

1. Face-to-Face Communication

Advantages

- Immediate feedback
- Clear understanding
- Personal interaction

Disadvantages

- Time consuming
- Costly for remote teams

2. Email

Advantages

- Fast communication
- Written record

- Easy to share

Disadvantages

- Misinterpretation
- Overload of emails

3. Telephone

Advantages

- Quick communication
- Personal contact

Disadvantages

- No permanent record
- Misunderstanding possible

4. Written Letters

Advantages

- Formal communication
- Legal documentation

Disadvantages

- Slow
- Expensive

5. Video Conferencing

Advantages

- Remote communication
- Face interaction

Disadvantages

- Technical problems
- Internet required

Step 2 — Writing

Writing includes:

- Draft message
- Use 7Cs
- Organize content
- Choose tone

Message Structure

Opening

State purpose

Body

Explain details

Closing

Action or conclusion

Step 3 — Completing

Completing includes:

1. Revising

Check:

- Clarity
- Organization
- Tone

2. Editing

Check:

- Grammar
- Spelling
- Punctuation

3. Proofreading

Final review before sending

4. Formatting

Make message professional

5. Sending

Send through selected channel

- **Direct Approach** - Main idea presented at the beginning

Used For

- Good news
- Routine messages
- Positive responses

Direct Approach Structure

1. Main idea
2. Explanation
3. Closing

Example — Direct Approach

Subject: Leave Approval

"Your leave request has been approved. You may take leave from 10 June to 15 June. Please complete pending tasks before leaving."

- **Indirect Approach** - Main idea presented **later in message**

Used For

- Bad news
- Sensitive messages
- Persuasive messages

Indirect Approach Structure

1. Buffer

2. Explanation
3. Bad news
4. Closing

Example — Indirect Approach

Subject: Job Application

"Thank you for your interest in our company. We received many applications. After careful consideration, we regret to inform you that you were not selected. We wish you success in your future career."

Direct vs Indirect Approach

Direct Approach	Indirect Approach
Main idea first	Main idea later
Good news	Bad news
Short	Detailed
Saves time	Maintains relationships

Example Comparison

Direct

"Your request is approved."

Indirect

"Thank you for your request. After review, your request is approved."

Week-7 Detailed Notes

According to Chapter 9, routine and good-news messages usually use the direct approach, which presents the main idea first, followed by explanation and a courteous close.

PART 1 — Writing Routine Messages

What are Routine Messages?

Routine messages are day-to-day business communications that involve requests, replies, confirmations, or sharing routine information.

These messages:

- Are common in business communication
- Usually involve neutral or positive information
- Use direct approach
- Should be clear and concise

Types of Routine Messages

Routine messages include:

1. Request for information
2. Request for action
3. Request for recommendations

4. Claims and adjustments
5. Confirmations
6. Routine replies
7. Sharing routine information

Structure of Routine Messages

Routine messages follow **three-step structure**:

- A. State Your Request Upfront**
- B. Explain and Justify Your Request**
- C. Request Specific Action in a Courteous Close**

A. State Your Request Upfront

Start your message **directly with your request**.

Why Start Directly?

- Saves time
- Shows professionalism
- Improves clarity
- Helps reader understand purpose immediately

Examples

Weak Opening

"I hope you are doing well. I am writing this email to request..."

Strong Opening

"Please send the updated sales report for March."

More Examples

"Please approve the marketing budget."

"Kindly provide the customer feedback report."

"Please confirm the meeting schedule."

B. Explain and Justify Your Request

After stating request, explain:

- Why you need information
- How it will be used
- Why it is important

This increases **cooperation and understanding**.

Example

"Please send the updated sales report for March so we can prepare the quarterly performance presentation."

Another Example

"Please provide the list of new employees so we can prepare ID cards."

C. Request Specific Action in a Courteous Close

End with:

- Clear action
- Deadline
- Polite tone
- Appreciation

Example

"Please send the report by Friday. Thank you for your cooperation."

Complete Routine Message Example

Subject: Request for Sales Report

"Please send the updated sales report for March. We need this information to prepare the quarterly presentation. Kindly send the report by Friday. Thank you for your cooperation."

Guidelines for Writing Routine Messages

- Use direct approach
- Be polite
- Be concise
- Be clear
- Provide deadline
- Maintain professional tone

Common Routine Requests Examples

1. Request for Information

Subject: Request for Product Details

"Please provide details of your new product line. We are interested in placing an order. Kindly send the information by tomorrow."

2. Request for Action

Subject: Budget Approval

"Please approve the marketing budget. We need approval to proceed with campaign planning. Kindly confirm by today."

3. Request for Recommendation

Subject: Recommendation Letter

"Please provide a recommendation letter for my promotion application. Your feedback will support my application. Kindly send it by Monday."

4. Claims and Adjustment

Subject: Damaged Products

"We received damaged items in our recent shipment. Please replace the items at your earliest convenience."

PART 2 — Writing Good-News Messages

What are Good-News Messages?

Good-news messages deliver positive or favorable information.

These messages:

- Build goodwill
- Strengthen relationships
- Encourage motivation

Types of Good-News Messages

1. Internal Good News

2. External Good News

Structure of Good-News Messages

Good-news messages follow **Direct Approach**:

1. Start with good news
2. Provide details
3. End with positive close

1. Start with Good News

Start message with positive information.

Example

"We are pleased to announce..."

"We are happy to inform you..."

"We are delighted to share..."

2. Provide Details

After good news, explain:

- Important information
- Additional details
- Benefits

3. End with Positive Close

End with:

- Encouragement
- Appreciation
- Goodwill

1. Internal Good News

Internal good news is shared within organization.

Examples

- Promotion
- Bonus
- Salary increase
- Policy change
- Training opportunities

Example — Internal Good News

Subject: Promotion Announcement

"We are pleased to announce that Ahmed Khan has been promoted to Sales Manager. His leadership and dedication contributed to company success. Please join us in congratulating him."

Example — Bonus Announcement

Subject: Bonus Announcement

"We are pleased to announce a performance bonus for all employees. Your hard work contributed to company success. Thank you for your dedication."

2. External Good News

External good news is shared outside organization.

Examples

- Product launch
- Business expansion
- Discount offers
- New services
- Partnerships

Example — External Good News

Subject: New Branch Opening

"We are pleased to announce the opening of our new branch in Lahore. This expansion will help us serve customers better. We look forward to welcoming you."

Example — Discount Announcement

Subject: Special Discount Offer

"We are pleased to announce a 20% discount on all products. This offer is available for limited time. Visit our store today."

Tone of Good-News Messages

Good-news messages should be:

- Positive
- Friendly
- Professional
- Encouraging

Comparison: Routine vs Good-News Messages

Routine Messages	Good-News Messages
Request information	Provide positive news
Direct approach	Direct approach
Professional tone	Friendly tone
Short	Positive

Practice Section

Practice Example 1 — Routine Message

Subject: Request for Meeting Schedule

"Please share the meeting schedule for next week. We need this information to plan project activities. Kindly send the schedule by tomorrow."

Practice Example 2 — Internal Good News

Subject: Training Program

"We are pleased to announce a new training program for employees. This program will help improve skills and performance. We encourage everyone to participate."

Practice Example 3 — External Good News

Subject: Product Launch

"We are excited to introduce our new product line. These products offer improved quality and affordability. We look forward to serving you."

WEEK-8 Detailed Notes

1. Introduction — Writing Bad-News Messages

Bad-news messages are messages that convey negative, disappointing, or unfavorable information.

Examples:

- Refusing a request
- Rejecting job application
- Denying claim
- Delayed delivery
- Price increase
- Layoffs
- Product cancellation

Bad-news messages are difficult because they must accomplish multiple goals simultaneously.

2. Goals of Negative Messages

When writing bad-news messages, you may have five major goals:

1. Convey the bad news
2. Gain acceptance of bad news
3. Maintain goodwill
4. Protect reputation
5. Reduce future communication

These goals require careful planning and execution.

3. The Three-Step Writing Process for Negative Messages

Negative messages follow:

1. Planning
2. Writing
3. Completing

STEP 1 — Planning a Negative Message

Planning is most important in negative communication.

Important Planning Considerations

- Audience needs
- Purpose
- Medium/channel
- Emotional impact
- Relationship with audience

Choosing the Medium

Selecting the correct communication medium is important.

Example:

Situation	Best Medium
Layoffs	Face-to-face
Routine rejection	Email
Formal refusal	Letter

Delivering bad news in person shows respect and professionalism.

Choosing Direct vs Indirect Approach

Two approaches:

1. Direct Approach
2. Indirect Approach

Direct Approach

Use Direct Approach when:

- Audience expects bad news
- Routine matter
- Emotional impact low
- Urgent situation

Structure of Direct Approach

1. State bad news
2. Provide reasons
3. Additional information
4. Respectful close

Example — Direct Approach

Subject: Leave Request

"Your leave request cannot be approved at this time. We are short-staffed. You may apply again next month."

Indirect Approach

Use Indirect Approach when:

- Emotional impact high

- Bad news unexpected
- Relationship important
- Reader emotionally involved

Structure of Indirect Approach

1. Buffer
2. Reasons
3. Bad news
4. Additional information
5. Respectful close

STEP 2 — Writing Negative Messages

When writing negative messages:

- Use respectful tone
- Avoid blame
- Use positive language
- Be clear and honest

Example:

Negative tone

"You made a mistake."

Better tone

"There appears to be an error."

STEP 3 — Completing Negative Messages

Completing includes:

- Revising
- Editing
- Proofreading
- Deliver promptly

Delaying bad news may be **unethical**.

4. Using Direct Approach for Negative Messages

Structure

1. Open with Bad News

Example:

"Your application was not selected."

2. Provide Reasons

Example:

"We received many qualified applicants."

3. Close Respectfully

Example:

"We wish you success in future."

Example — Direct Approach

Subject: Job Application

"Your application was not selected. We received many qualified candidates. We appreciate your interest in our company."

5. Using Indirect Approach for Negative Messages

Indirect approach is most commonly used.

Step 1 — Buffer

Buffer is:

Neutral opening statement

No bad news

Purpose:

- Reduce shock
- Maintain goodwill
- Prepare reader

Types of Buffers

According to the book, buffers include:

1. Agreement
2. Appreciation
3. Cooperation
4. Fairness
5. Good news
6. Praise
7. Understanding

Example:

"Thank you for your interest in our company."

Step 2 — Provide Reasons

Explain why decision made.

Example:

"Due to budget constraints, we cannot hire additional staff."

Step 3 — State Bad News

Deliver politely.

Example:

"We are unable to hire additional staff."

Step 4 — Respectful Close

Example:

"We appreciate your understanding."

Example — Indirect Approach

Subject: Request Refusal

"Thank you for your request. Due to limited resources, we cannot approve your request. We appreciate your understanding."

6. The Empathetic “You” Approach

The You-approach focuses on reader's needs, feelings, and perspective. This helps reduce negative impact.

Poor Example

"We cannot process your request."

Better Example

"You can submit the request again next month."

7. Guidelines for You-Approach

- Focus on reader
- Use polite tone
- Show empathy
- Avoid blaming
- Avoid harsh words

Example

Poor:

"We failed to deliver your order."

Better:

"Your order will arrive next week."

Using Positive Language

Negative phrasing:

"The damage won't be fixed for a week."

Positive phrasing:

"The item will be repaired next week."

Maintaining Ethics and Etiquette

Important when delivering bad news.

Guidelines:

- Be honest
- Avoid misleading
- Deliver promptly
- Show sensitivity
- Consider emotional impact

Example:

Layoff message must be written carefully.

8. Sending Negative Messages on Routine Business Matters

Routine negative messages include:

- Rejecting suggestions
- Refusing requests
- Delays
- Policy changes

9. Rejecting Suggestions

Use indirect approach.

Example:

"Thank you for your suggestion. After review, we cannot implement it at this time."

10. Refusing Routine Requests

Direct approach usually works.

Example:

"We are unable to approve your request."

11. Handling Bad News About Transactions

Examples:

- Delivery delay
- Out-of-stock items
- Billing errors

Steps:

1. Reset expectations
2. Explain problem
3. Offer solution
4. Apologize if necessary

Example

"Your order is delayed due to supply shortage. We expect delivery next week. Thank you for your patience."

12. Refusing Claims

Customers are emotionally involved.

Use indirect approach.

Steps:

1. Acknowledge complaint
2. Explain reason
3. Refuse claim
4. Offer solution

Example

"Thank you for contacting us. After review, we cannot replace the item because warranty expired. However, we offer a discount."

13. Negative Organizational News

Examples:

- Layoffs
- Price increase
- Product cancellation

Guidelines

- Match approach to situation
- Consider audience needs
- Give time to react
- Avoid false optimism

14. Responding to Negative Information (Social Media)

Steps:

1. Engage early
2. Monitor conversation
3. Evaluate message
4. Respond appropriately

Links – Chapter 03 (Material)

 Organizational communication is the process of sharing information within an organization to achieve goals, coordinate work, and improve performance.

Types

- **Internal communication** — within the organization (employees, managers, teams)
- **External communication** — outside the organization (customers, suppliers, public)

Forms

- **Formal communication** — emails, reports, meetings
- **Informal communication** — casual conversations, team chats

Importance

Organizational communication helps to:

- Improve teamwork
- Increase productivity
- Support decision-making
- Build relationships
- Solve problems

Organizational communication helps organizations run smoothly, achieve goals, and improve workplace relationships.

 The three main types of information sources used in research:

1. Primary Sources

Primary sources are original and first-hand information created from direct research or experience.

Examples

- Research articles
- Experiments
- Surveys
- Interviews
- Data sets
- Observations

Primary sources provide new and original information and are considered most reliable for research.

2. Secondary Sources

Secondary sources analyze, interpret, or summarize primary sources.

Examples

- Books
- Review articles
- Textbooks
- Journal reviews
- Commentaries

Secondary sources help understand and explain primary research.

3. Tertiary Sources

Tertiary sources compile and organize information from primary and secondary sources.

Examples

- Encyclopedias
- Dictionaries
- Indexes
- Handbooks
- Almanacs

These sources provide quick reference information.

Source Type	Purpose	Examples
Primary	Original information	Experiments, surveys
Secondary	Analysis of primary	Books, reviews
Tertiary	Summary/compiled info	Encyclopedias, dictionaries

- **Primary** → Original information
- **Secondary** → Analysis of primary
- **Tertiary** → Summary of both

Three Types of Decisions

According to the article, organizations make three main types of decisions:

1. Structured Decisions

Structured decisions are routine and repetitive decisions that follow clear rules and procedures.

- These decisions occur frequently
- Easy to automate
- Require little judgment

Examples

- Reordering inventory
- Payroll calculation
- Hiring process using standard criteria

These decisions save time because procedures already exist.

2. Unstructured Decisions

Unstructured decisions are complex and non-routine decisions that require judgment, experience, and insight.

- No clear procedure
- Unique situations
- Usually made by top management

Examples

- Entering a new market
- Launching new product
- Company expansion

These decisions are novel and important, and information systems help managers analyze them.

3. Semi-Structured Decisions

Semi-structured decisions are partly structured and partly unstructured.

- Some parts follow rules
- Some parts require judgment
- Usually made by middle management

Examples

- Budget planning
- Sales forecasting
- Marketing decisions

These decisions require both procedures and human judgment.

Decision-Making Stages (Also Mentioned in Article)

The article also mentions four stages of decision-making:

1. **Intelligence** — Identify problem
2. **Design** — Find possible solutions
3. **Choice** — Select best option
4. **Implementation** — Apply decision and evaluate results

Decision Type	Nature	Example
Structured	Routine	Payroll
Semi-structured	Partly routine	Budget planning
Unstructured	Complex	Enter new market

- **Structured** → Routine decisions
 - **Semi-structured** → Mixed decisions
 - **Unstructured** → Complex decisions
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